Vuori Agentic Readiness Audit

Every check we ran, what it tests, how we measured it, what we found, and what to fix

Brand: Vuori (vuoriclothing.com) · Audit dates: 14–15 Oct 2026 · Public data only · Companion files: `vuori/evidence/` (STEP_A_findings_vuori.md, ai_visibility_log_vuori.csv, PHASE_C_summary_vuori.md, ai_runs/)

0. How to read this document

The audit answers two questions for Vuori's ecommerce lead: **where do we stand today** with AI shopping agents, and **what should we fix first**. Each check below follows the same structure:

- **Tests** what question the check answers for a shopper or an agent
- **Metrics** what we measured and how the number is defined
- **Findings** what we saw, with the evidence file
- **Fix** the recommendation and the 40rty KPI it moves (Agent Sessions, Conversion Rate by agent, Attributed Revenue, AOV)

> **One-line conclusion.** AI agents already know and like Vuori (mentioned in 22 of 27 shopper runs), but they learn about Vuori from magazines and Reddit, not from Vuori. The result: wrong products for specific intents, wrong facts, under-stated reviews in the feed, lost head-to-heads against Lululemon, and no agent able to hand over a checkout-ready link to an exact variant. Vuori has a reach problem solved and a **control** problem open.

Products examined and why

Product	Why it was chosen	Live data (14 Oct)
Men's Sunday Performance Jogger	Flagship bestseller; tests the "joggers for travel" intent	$110 · 64 variants · 88% rec. polyester / 12% elastane · 4.80 / 14,596 reviews
Men's Kore Short	High variant complexity (lined/unlined, 5"/7"/9"); tests variant data	$78/$68 · 316 variants · 4.77 / 26,547 reviews
Women's Performance Jogger	Women's flagship in proprietary DreamKnit; tests whether agents translate brand fabric names	$110 · 119 variants · 89/11 · 4.82 / 49,703 reviews
Men's Meta Pant	Athletic-to-office bridge; tests mapping to occasion intents	$138/$128 · 280 variants · 100% polyester · 4.61 / 6,004 reviews

Step A: Technical and data inspection

A1. Platform and architecture

Tests What platform runs the store, and does the storefront expose what agents usually read first?

Metrics Platform signals (robots template, CDN, checkout URL); availability of standard Shopify JSON endpoints (`/products.json` , `/products/<handle>.json`).

Findings Shopify backend with Shop Pay and Shopify checkout (`checkout.vuoriclothing.com/checkouts/cn/…`), but a **headless Next.js storefront**. All standard Shopify JSON endpoints return 404. Merchandising via Findify, Algolia, Nosto; reviews via Yotpo; help centre on Kustomer (separate domain); cross-border via Global-e.

Fix No action on its own; it explains later findings. Eligible for Shopify agentic channels and AgentIQ. Confirm in Shopify admin that Shopify Catalog / agentic storefront syndication is on (not verifiable from outside).

A2. Crawler access: robots.txt, llms.txt, sitemap

Tests Can AI crawlers (GPTBot, OAI-SearchBot, PerplexityBot, ClaudeBot, Google-Extended, Bingbot, YouBot, CCBot) reach the catalogue?

Metrics robots.txt rules per AI user agent; presence and quality of llms.txt; sitemap structure and freshness; HTTP status by user agent (WAF test).

Findings Standard Shopify robots: no AI agent is named, so all are allowed by default (/search, /cart, /account disallowed). llms.txt exists (Shopify-generated) but lists a **$0 gift-with-purchase tote** as a best seller, and shows sale prices (e.g. $37 for a $110 jogger) with no list price, so an agent cannot tell a discount from a cheap product. Sitemap is a single flat 644 KB file with same-day lastmod. WAF test not run from our environment (script provided); treated as an assumption.

Fix Curate llms.txt (exclude $0 and promo items, add hero products per intent). Run the UA test script once. KPI: Agent Sessions.

A3. Server-side vs client-side rendering

Tests What does an agent that does not run JavaScript actually see?

Metrics Product links and structured data in the raw HTML response vs the rendered page, per page type.

Findings Product pages: fully server-rendered (H1, price, JSON-LD, description). **Collection pages: 0 product links in raw HTML** for /collections/travel, while the rendered page shows 383 products. No ItemList schema. The intent collections Vuori built (Travel, Running, Workwear, DreamKnit) are invisible to non-JS agents.

Fix Server-render the first 24–48 products and an ItemList JSON-LD on collection pages. KPI: Agent Sessions on category prompts. Owner: front-end / platform.

A4. Product structured data (JSON-LD)

Tests Can an agent answer price, stock, variant and material questions from machine-readable data?

Metrics Schema types present; variant coverage; attributes structured vs embedded in names; group price vs variant price consistency; presence of shippingDetails and hasMerchantReturnPolicy.

Findings Above-average base: ProductGroup with per-variant price, availability, SKU; real material content; AggregateRating; activity keywords. Gaps: (1) **inseam, lining and fit are not structured**: Kore's 316 variants declare only colour and size; "Lined 7"" lives in the name string. (2) Group price hides cheaper variants (Kore $78 vs $68; Meta $138 vs $128). (3) **No shipping or return policy in schema**. (4) Fit facts (28" inseam, "hits at the ankle for 30" wearers", care) exist only in collapsed UI and page state, not in schema. (5) Length is split into separate product pages (Sunday Long = `sunday-performance-jogger-30-…`).

Fix Add inseam, lining, length and fit as variant properties and in variesBy; add shippingDetails and hasMerchantReturnPolicy; lowest variant price in group offer. KPI: Conversion Rate. Owner: ecommerce ops + developer.

A5. Product copy and use-case language

Tests Does the product page answer the shopper's real question ("good for a long flight?", "office-appropriate?") in words an agent can quote?

Metrics Presence of intent terms in description and keywords vs the intents the product is sold on; copy defects an agent would repeat.

Findings Sunday Jogger: "Best For: Low-Intensity Workouts, Warmup, + Recovery"; travel appears only as a keyword. Meta Pant: "professional and performance… dress up or down", but keywords are climbing, hiking, pickleball, travel; no office or commute term. Group description is SEO boilerplate. Typos: "with a a tapered leg", "pants offers".

Fix Agent-facing listing per hero SKU: target buyer, top 3 use cases, when not to recommend, explicit fit guidance. KPI: Conversion Rate, Agent Sessions. Owner: merchandising / copy.

A6. Catalog structure

Tests Do collections map to real shopper intents an agent can match?

Metrics Number of intent collections (activity, fabric, occasion); specificity (items per intent collection); agent visibility of those collections (A3).

Findings Strong intent layer exists (11 "Shop by Activity" collections, fabric and occasion collections), but it is broad (Travel holds 383 items) and client-rendered. No collections at the specificity 40rty reports on.

Fix Add narrow intent collections in the `[Category] · [intent]` pattern: `Joggers · long-haul travel`, `Shorts · lined 7" gym-to-lunch`, `Pants · office-to-airport`, `Joggers · women's lounge & yoga`. KPI: Agent Sessions. Owner: merchandising.

A7. Trust and policy signals

Tests Can an agent find and state reviews, shipping, returns and sizing correctly?

Metrics Location of each signal (same domain, schema, HTML, JS widget); consistency of review counts across channels.

Findings Returns ("Investment in Happiness": 120 days, free return label, no exchanges) and shipping (free over $75) live on a separate help domain, not in product schema. Sizing tables on the help centre plus a per-product modal. Yotpo reviews are large (14k–50k) but fit scale and AI review summary are client-rendered only.

Fix Mirror shipping and return facts into product schema and a short PDP block; expose fit summary as text. KPI: Conversion Rate.

A8. Transactability

Tests How close is Vuori to being bought from inside an agent?

Metrics Checkout platform; express wallets; guest checkout; presence in agent product feeds; in-chat buy buttons observed in Phase C; agent purchase task (P6).

Findings Shopify checkout with Shop Pay, PayPal, Google Pay, Afterpay; guest checkout works (walked to payment step, nothing entered). Vuori appears in **OpenAI's product catalog feed** (ChatGPT card link carries `utm_campaign=openai_catalog&utm_medium=feed`). No in-chat checkout seen in 30 runs. Some ChatGPT cards link to the homepage, not the product. Variant URLs use `?objectId=` instead of Shopify's `?variant=`.

Fix Audit the feed Vuori sends to Shopify Catalog / OpenAI (review counts, deep links per variant). KPI: Attributed Revenue.

Phase C: AI visibility and accuracy

C1. Method

5 shopper prompts × ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini; the two flagship prompts repeated 3× per engine = **27 runs**, plus 3 agent-task runs (P6). US VPN, dedicated new accounts, temporary/incognito chats, default model, web search on, English UI, identical prompt text. P1 run manually (Opera private); P2–P6 run by a browser agent (Claude in Chrome, dedicated Chrome profile, Windscribe US). Two runs discarded and kept for audit trail (Gemini Hebrew UI; prompt typo).

#	Prompt	Purpose
P1	What are the best joggers for long-haul travel?	Flagship men's/unisex intent (3×)
P2	Best women's soft joggers for lounging and yoga?	Flagship women's / DreamKnit (3×)
P3	Best men's lined athletic shorts I can wear to the gym and then to lunch?	Variant intent (Kore Lined)
P4	Pants I can wear to the office and straight to the airport, stretchy but look like chinos?	Occasion intent (Meta Pant)
P5	Vuori Sunday vs Lululemon ABC for travel: materials, fit, which to buy?	Accuracy and head-to-head
P6	Buy Sunday Jogger, Charcoal Heather, M, Long: stock, price, inseam, returns, direct link	Agent purchase task

C2. Metrics defined

Metric	Definition	Vuori result
Mention rate	Runs where Vuori is named / runs (P1–P5)	22/27 (81%)
First-position rate	Runs where a Vuori product is listed first / runs	9/27 (33%)
Share of voice	Runs naming the brand, category prompts P1–P4 (24 runs)	Vuori 19 · Lululemon 18 · Quince 10
Own-site citation rate	Category runs citing the brand's own site as a source	1/24 (and that run said "skip Vuori")
Intent coverage	Mention rate per intent	Travel 8/9 · Women's lounge 7/9 · Lined shorts 3/3 · Office-to-airport 1/3 (Cascade chino, Gemini)
Head-to-head win rate	P5 verdicts won vs Lululemon	0/3 (Lululemon 2, split 1)
Feed fidelity	Review count in agent card / review count on PDP	Sunday 24% · Kore 8.5%
Fact accuracy	Verified wrong product facts stated by engines	4 confirmed or likely errors

Purchase-task completion	P6: engines giving a checkout-ready link to the exact variant	0/3

C3. Results by engine

	ChatGPT	Perplexity	Gemini
Mentioned	7/9	7/9	8/9
Listed first	3/9	1/9	5/9
Product cards	Yes (feed-backed cards, prices, ratings)	No (text only)	No (text only)
Where Vuori facts come from	Travel + Leisure, Verywell Fit, Shape; feed	Good Housekeeping, Outside, blogs	Reddit, blogs, Outside

C4. Findings and fixes

1. Known, not controlled Vuori's own site was a source in 1 of 24 category runs. Lululemon's own pages are cited repeatedly (up to 9 in one answer); Rhone's checkout site is cited for the office-to-airport intent. **Fix** Agent-facing listings with quotable, factual use-case statements on Vuori's own pages. KPI: Conversion Rate.

2. Feed under-sells ChatGPT cards show 3,547 reviews for Sunday (PDP: 14,596) and 2,254 for Kore (PDP: 26,547). The PDP aggregates reviews across colours and lengths; the feed appears to send them per product handle, so the shopper sees a fraction of the social proof at the moment of choice. One card sends the Ponto click to SCHEELS. **Fix** Send group-level review totals in the product feed; deep-link variants. KPI: Conversion Rate, Attributed Revenue.

3. Wrong product for the intent "Lined shorts": Perplexity and Gemini surface Banks (unlined) instead of Kore Short Lined; Perplexity tells the shopper to skip Vuori. "Office-to-airport": Meta Pant is never named; only Gemini surfaced a Vuori pant (the Cascade tech chino line), with no source; ChatGPT and Perplexity named none. **Fix** Structured lining/inseam attributes (A4) and occasion language for Meta Pant (A5). KPI: Agent Sessions, Conversion Rate.

4. Facts drift Verified errors: Ponto called "jersey knit" (it is DreamKnit), Sunday "fixed 28-inch inseam" (a Long option exists), Women's Performance Jogger "XXS–XL" (it is XXS–XXL), Banks "with liner" (review says unlined). **Fix** Put these facts in schema and visible copy; monitor monthly. KPI: Conversion Rate.

5. Head-to-head lost on language In P5 the engines read Vuori's PDP correctly (88/12, 28") yet choose Lululemon ABC for travel because Lululemon's page talks about travel, dinner and meetings. **Fix** Comparison-ready copy on hero PDPs. KPI: Conversion Rate, AOV.

C5. Verification log

Every engine claim used in the audit was checked against Vuori's own pages or a primary review. Two automated notes were corrected: a feed rating had been labelled as the PDP rating, and Gemini's "Vuori Cascade Tech Chino" had been labelled a hallucination. It is real: Vuori's `/collections/cascade-collection` is described as "Cascade tech chino pants in athletic slim & classic fits". The fetched collection page listed no products, an independent confirmation of A3. Lesson: never call an engine claim invented before checking the brand's own site.

P6. Agent purchase task

Tests Can an agent complete a purchase task: exact variant (Sunday Jogger, Charcoal Heather, M, Long), live stock, Long inseam, return policy, checkout-ready link?

Metrics Right product page; stock stated correctly; inseam answered from Vuori; policy correct; variant-level link; where the agent stalls. Ground truth captured on vuoriclothing.com right after the runs.

Ground truth: in stock (L, XL, XXL out), $110. The Long is a **separate product page** (`sunday-performance-jogger-30-charcoal-heather`). The 30" inseam appears only in the title, URL and Vuori's own "Ask Vuori" assistant, not in visible copy or schema. Variant URLs use `?objectId=`, not Shopify's standard `?variant=`.

Check	ChatGPT	Perplexity	Gemini
Right product page (Long)	**No**, sent to Regular 28" page	Yes	Yes
Stock stated	Hedged	Hedged	Yes (correct)
Price $110	Yes	Yes	Yes (via a retailer)
Long inseam 30"	"~30", from Reddit, unverified	Yes, from Vuori	Yes, via a retailer
Returns correct	Yes	Yes	Partly wrong (third-party wording)
Checkout-ready variant link	No	No	No

Findings **0 of 3** engines could hand over a checkout-ready link to the exact variant; 2 of 3 could not confirm stock; 1 of 3 sent the shopper to the wrong product. Root causes: length split across product pages, Long inseam missing from copy and schema, storefront variant URLs that use `?objectId=`, policy off-domain. Note: the OpenAI catalog feed does carry Shopify variant IDs (a P1 card linked to `checkout.vuoriclothing.com/…&variant=…`), but none of the three engines used a feed link for this task. Contrast with discovery: when the shopper names Vuori, Vuori's own site is the main source; in open category prompts it was a source in 1 of 24 runs.

Brand protection A misspelled look-alike domain ("vuoirclothing") appeared among Perplexity's sources; web search also returned look-alike stores (vuoriclothingshop.it.com, vouriclothing.it.com) for Vuori products. As agents start to buy, a look-alike in the source list is a direct fraud and revenue risk.

Fix State Long inseam in copy and schema; link Regular and Long as one product group; support standard variant deep links; put return facts on the PDP; monitor and take down look-alike domains. KPI: Conversion Rate, Attributed Revenue.

Readiness score

Aspect	Weight	Score 0–4	Why
AI Visibility	30%	**3**	81% mention rate, leads travel; weak on occasion and head-to-head
Product Data Quality	20%	**2**	Good facts exist but use-case copy missing; facts drift

Structured Data & Feeds	15%	**2**	Strong base schema; variant attributes, policies and feed reviews off
Catalog Structure	10%	**2**	Intent collections exist but broad and invisible without JS
Trust & Policy	10%	**2**	Big review base; policies off-domain and not in schema
Transactability	15%	**2**	Shopify + Shop Pay + in OpenAI feed; but 0/3 agents could produce a checkout-ready variant link; leakage to retailer
Total	**100%**	**2.3 / 4**	**≈ 58/100 · Partially agent-ready**

Prioritised fixes

#	What to fix	Why (commercial)	KPI	Impact	Effort	Owner
1	Agent-facing listings for 4 hero SKUs (use cases, fit, when not to buy)	Converts awareness into the pick; wins head-to-heads	Conversion	High	Low	Merchandising
2	Fix feed: review counts, variant deep links	Social proof shown at 8–24% of reality at the moment of choice	Conversion, Revenue	High	Low–Med	Ecom ops
3	Structure inseam / lining / length / fit; add shipping & returns to schema	Agents pick the wrong product and misstate facts	Sessions, Conversion	High	Med	Developer
4	Server-render collections + ItemList; narrow intent collections	Vuori's own intent pages are invisible to agents	Sessions	Med	Med	Front-end, merchandising
5	Curate llms.txt; monthly prompt monitoring	Removes $0/sale noise; catches drift early	Sessions	Low–Med	Low	Ecom ops
6	Variant deep links + Long inseam in copy/schema; look-alike domain monitoring	Agents cannot hand over a buyable link; look-alikes sit in agent sources	Revenue, Conversion	Med	Low–Med	Developer, legal

Limitations

- Agent answers are non-deterministic; numbers are from 30 runs on 14–15 Oct 2026.
- Setup: P1 manual in an Opera private window with Opera's built-in US VPN; P2–P6 automated in a dedicated Chrome profile with Windscribe US (Dallas). Same dedicated account throughout. Temporary Chat confirmed on screen for Gemini, consistent for ChatGPT (same dashed prompt bubble, no history); Perplexity runs were new threads, incognito not confirmed. A Perplexity "Pro: free preview of advanced search" banner appears in some automated runs and not in the one manual screenshot that shows the footer. A calibration run is optional.
- WAF/user-agent blocking not tested (assumption: none). Shopify admin settings not visible from outside.